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100 DAYS OF TRUMP

Second term, second thoughts

President targets policies on trade, taxes from a previous administration: his own

By Sam Brodey
and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It's no surprise that upon returning to power, President Trump moved quickly to undo the liberal policies of his predecessor, Joe Biden.

What's more counterintuitive is that Trump has taken steps in the first 100 days of his second term to cast aside, or outright undo, key aspects of his own first term.

Take the US-Canada-Mexico free trade agreement, or USMCA, which Trump brokered during his

first term. Just weeks into his second term, Trump imperiled the agreement by threatening Canada and Mexico with 25 percent tariffs, claiming he needed to force the two nations to address security concerns at their borders and also revitalize the domestic auto industry.

While Trump has adjusted the threats and tariff timeline, trade analysts say the viability of the

USMCA is very much in doubt.

"This is really something he brought to fruition," said Joshua Meltzer, a senior fellow at the Brookings Institution who leads the think tank's USMCA Initiative. "And in short order, he pulled it apart again."

Another key first-term economic policy is facing outright extinction. Even before he won the 2024

TRUMP, Page A6

Will young voters stand by Markey again?

Some ex-supporters say it's time for new generation of leaders

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

In 2020, Abhi Agarwal was all-in to reelect Massachusetts Senator Ed Markey.

Sent home his first year of college by the COVID-19 pandemic, Agarwal was one of hundreds of young people who powered the "Markeyverse" — an online movement that helped the incumbent fend off a primary challenge from former representative Joseph Kennedy III, who is 34 years his junior. Later that fall, Agarwal joined the wave of young people who helped Joe Biden defeat Donald Trump.

But four years later, with Trump back on the ballot, the 24-year-old software engineer said he wrote in Celtics star Jayson Tatum for the presidency — a move fueled by a growing distaste for politics.

It's a disenchantment that applies to the 78-year-old senator Agarwal once championed. "I probably wouldn't vote for him again because I think he's old and needs to go," Agarwal said of Markey. "I want politicians who feel like they're fighting for something rather than letting the time pass them by. . . . I want Democrats to have a little bit of life in them."

That attitude captures the potential challenge awaiting Markey as he mounts

MARKEY, Page A7

Struggling seniors look for support

Say \$72.80 monthly allowance isn't enough

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

What can you afford on \$2.42 a day? For nearly 20 years, thousands of low-income Massachusetts nursing home and rest home residents have had to figure that out because they have access to just \$72.80 per month from their own Social Security checks to cover personal needs. These are often small items, but residents say they can have a profound impact on their lives, like being able to buy a birthday gift for a grandchild, orthotic shoes not covered by insurance to help ease aching feet, or just to treat themselves to a haircut.

The rest of their income goes toward their care, including meals and housing.

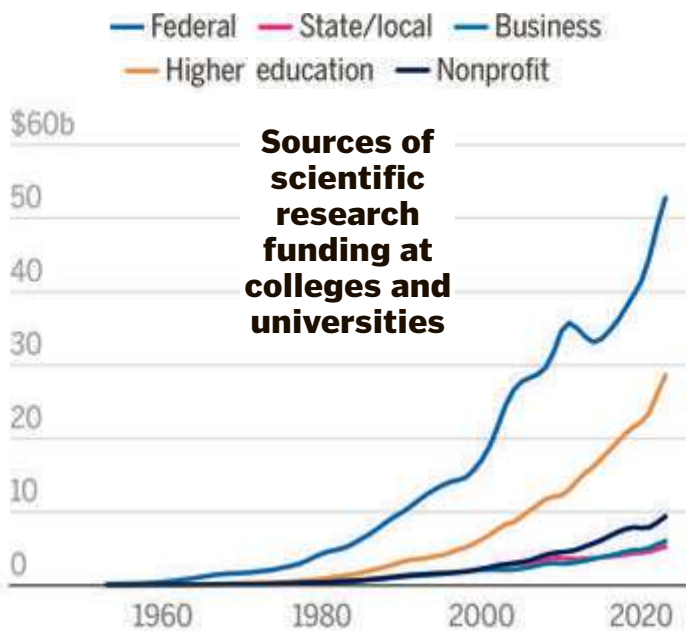
Attempts over the years to persuade state lawmakers to increase the \$72.80 "personal needs allowance" have fallen short, not because of any organized resistance against the matter, but a general consensus that other needs were

BENEFIT, Page A4



EVGENIY MALOLETKA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Alyona Zavadska, 16, (center) was surrounded by friends at the coffin of her boyfriend, Danylo Khudia, 17, killed in a Russian strike last week along with his parents, Viktoria and Oleh. The funeral ceremony Monday was held at the crematorium in Kyiv. Russian forces have continued to pound Ukraine despite efforts by President Trump to forge a lasting cease-fire. **A3.**



Figures in current US dollars. "Federal" refers to federal government funding. "State/local" refers to state and local government funding. "Higher education" is research funding provided by the colleges and universities themselves.

Chart: CHRISTINA PRIGNANO/GLOBE STAFF • Source: National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics

Next key discovery for scientists? A cash source.

Labs turn to states, colleges, nonprofits

By Amanda Gokee,
Jonathan Saltzman,
and Robert Weisman
GLOBE STAFF

The funding geyser that propelled US medical advances for much of the past century may be drying up as the Trump administration pulls back federal research money from Harvard University and other New England institutions that have been reliable engines of discovery and innovation.

Yet as labs scramble for alternative funding sources — from foundations, industry, even their university hosts — there's little hope, in the short term, that those players

can fill the gaps resulting from White House rollbacks.

"The extent of the federal investment in research, including biomedical research, is the reason the US has been dominant in research worldwide," said Dr. Dan Barouch, head of the Center for Virology and Vaccine Research at Harvard-affiliated Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center, whose lab helped develop a COVID-19 vaccine. "If the federal government stops supporting research, the US will lose its global dominance."

Budget cuts from the National Institutes of Health, the National Science Foundation, and other federal agencies have prompted pushback from the academic community but also some sober reflections

RESEARCH, Page A6

School bus hits, kills boy

Tragedy occurred after he left bus to go home in Hyde Park. **B1.**

Actors help nursing students learn how to best talk with patients, including when it's time to break the bad news. **D1.**

The Trump administration has dismissed the hundreds of scientists who had been compiling the federal government's flagship report on how global warming is affecting the country, putting the document's future in doubt. **A2.**

The Liberal Party won Canada's federal election, capping a stunning turnaround. **A3.**

T bringing signal system into computer age

Long a cause of irritation, delays, network a top priority

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

During a recent morning rush hour, a signal problem near Quincy Center froze the commutes of Red Line riders. At the JFK/UMass Station, a couple hundred riders stood shoulder to shoulder, waiting and waiting for the subway to arrive.

"The trains were so packed," said Samantha Mascari, 34, of Dorchester, who was on the platform.

Some people shoved their way onboard, but after standing there for over a half-hour, Mascari opted to take the commuter rail into Boston, where she does software implementation. "It's just horrible timing."

For riders, signal problems are a familiar irritation. With the MBTA's analog system, which dates back to the 1970s and is considered obsolete, one failure among thousands of individual points connecting the electrical equipment can ruin many a

SIGNALS, Page A5



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

David Byrne, MBTA deputy director of signals, explained how the computer system inside the signal room works to monitor trains.



To sun degree

Tuesday: Partly sunny, toasty.
High 75-80, low 59-64.

Wednesday: Fully sunny.
High 67-72, low 44-49.
Sunrise: 5:42. Sunset: 7:42.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C10.**

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